Cinematic effects cheat sheet

Tick these in the Prompt Builder, or type them into the [SLOTS] of the scene prompt formula. Camera-move names are Higgsfield's presets (higgsfield.ai/camera-controls); the meanings are this course's plain-English glosses.

Camera moves (Higgsfield presets)

Term	What it does
Static	Camera holds still; let the action move.
Handheld	Slight human shake; feels real and urgent.
Dolly In	Camera glides toward the subject; builds focus or tension.
Dolly Out	Camera glides away; reveals context or loneliness.
Dolly Left	Camera slides left past the subject.
Dolly Right	Camera slides right past the subject.
Super Dolly In	A long, fast push from wide to close.
Super Dolly Out	A long pull from close to very wide.
Double Dolly	Subject and camera travel together; the subject seems to glide.
Dolly Zoom In	Background warps while the subject stays the same size; a realisation.
Dolly Zoom Out	The reverse warp; the world closes in.
Zoom In	Lens zooms in; the camera stays put.
Zoom Out	Lens zooms out; reveals the wider scene.
Crash Zoom In	Sudden, violent zoom in; shock or comic beat.
Crash Zoom Out	Sudden zoom out; the floor drops away.
Rapid Zoom In	Quick zoom in, smoother than a crash.
Rapid Zoom Out	Quick zoom out to reveal.
YoYo Zoom	Zooms in and back out in one beat; playful emphasis.
Eating Zoom	Pushes into a mouthful of food; the F&B hook.
Pan Left	Camera turns left on the spot to follow or reveal.
Pan Right	Camera turns right on the spot to follow or reveal.
Whip Pan	Very fast pan that blurs; energetic link between moments.
Tilt Up	Camera tips up; reveals height or status.
Tilt Down	Camera tips down; lands on a detail.
Arc Left	Camera circles part-way left around the subject.
Arc Right	Camera circles part-way right around the subject.
360 Orbit	Full circle around the subject; hero moment.
Lazy Susan	Subject turns as if on a turntable; product showcase.
3D Rotation	The scene rotates in 3D around the subject.
Crane Up	Camera rises high; opens or ends a scene.
Crane Down	Camera descends into the scene.
Crane Over The Head	Camera rises and sweeps over the subject.
Jib Up	A shorter rise; a small reveal.
Jib Down	A shorter drop to eye level.
Aerial Pullback	Pulls up and away into a wide aerial; a closing shot.
FPV Drone	Fast, swooping first-person drone flight.
Overhead	Straight down from above; flat-lay or map view.
Incline	Camera rises on a slant past the subject.
Dutch Angle	Tilted horizon; something is off.
Fisheye	Ultra-wide bulging lens; skate or street energy.
Focus Change	Focus pulls from one subject to another.
Low Shutter	Motion smears into streaks; dreamy or dazed.
Hyperlapse	Moving timelapse; time passes as the camera travels.
Timelapse Glam	Time races around a still subject being styled.
Timelapse Human	Subject stays still while the crowd rushes past.
Timelapse Landscape	Sky and light change fast over a place.
Bullet Time	Action freezes while the camera moves around it.

Through Object In	Camera passes through a gap or window into the scene.
Through Object Out	Camera exits through a gap or object.
Flying Cam Transition	Camera flies from one space into another; a built-in scene change.
Head Tracking	Camera locks onto a moving head.
Eyes In	Push into the eyes; an inner moment.
Mouth In	Push into the mouth; speech or eating emphasis.
Object POV	We see from an object's point of view: a phone, a cup, a tin.
Hero Cam	Low, rising move that makes the subject look heroic.
Snorricam	Camera rigged to the actor; the world sways around them.
Robo Arm	Precise, fast robotic-arm move; product or food.
Car Grip	Camera fixed to a car; driving dialogue.
Car Chasing	Camera chases a moving car.
Road Rush	Low, fast travel along a road.
Buckle Up	Intense push inside a moving vehicle.
BTS	Behind-the-scenes look with crew and gear in frame.
Glam	Slow, flattering beauty move.
Wiggle	Small playful back-and-forth shake.

Camera angles

Term	What it does
Eye level	Neutral; we meet the subject as an equal.
Low angle	Looking up; the subject feels powerful.
High angle	Looking down; the subject feels small or exposed.
Bird's-eye	Straight down; pattern and geography.
Worm's-eye	From the ground up; scale and awe.
Dutch angle	Tilted frame; tension or confusion.
Over-the-shoulder	From behind one person toward another; conversation.
POV	Through the character's eyes.
Profile	Side-on; contemplation or confrontation.
Three-quarter	Between front and profile; the flattering default.

Shot sizes

Term	What it does
EWS	Extreme wide: a tiny figure in a big world.
WS	Wide: full body plus the place.
MWS	Medium wide: knees up; body language.
MS	Medium: waist up; everyday dialogue.
MCU	Medium close-up: chest up; the talking-head standard.
CU	Close-up: the face fills the frame; emotion.
ECU	Extreme close-up: eyes, hands, a detail.
Insert	A cutaway of an object that matters.
Two-shot	Two people in one frame; relationship.

Lens

Term	What it does
14mm ultra-wide	Huge space, stretched edges; action or drama.
24mm wide	Room and subject together; vlogs and interiors.
35mm	Natural street-level view; versatile storytelling.
50mm	Close to the human eye; honest and calm.
85mm	Flattering portrait; soft background.

100mm macro	Tiny details big: food, labels, textures.
135mm telephoto	Compressed background; voyeur feel.
Anamorphic	Wide cinematic frame with oval bokeh and flares.
Shallow depth of field	Only the subject is sharp.
Deep focus	Everything sharp front to back.

Lighting

Term	What it does
Soft window light	Gentle, natural, flattering.
Golden hour	Warm, low sun; nostalgia and hope.
Blue hour	Cool dusk; quiet melancholy.
Single practical lamp	One visible lamp; intimate night scenes.
High-key	Bright, few shadows; ads and comedy.
Low-key	Dark with hard shadows; drama and mystery.
Neon night	Coloured signage light; city energy.
Backlit rim light	Light behind the subject outlines them.
Overcast	Flat and even; documentary feel.
Ring light	Even front light with eye catchlights; UGC.
Fluorescent office	Cool, flat, slightly green; workplace realism.

Mood

Term	What it does
Tense	Something is about to go wrong.
Tender	Warmth between people.
Hopeful	Things are turning around.
Playful	Light, funny, quick.
Urgent	No time to lose.
Nostalgic	A warm look back.
Triumphant	The win lands.
Awkward	Cringe the audience feels too.
Calm	Steady and reassuring.
Eerie	Quiet and unsettling.

Colour grade

Term	What it does
Teal & orange	Blockbuster contrast: warm skin, cool shadows.
Warm kopi browns	Coffee and cream tones; homely (the Kopi & Coins look).
Bleach bypass	Desaturated and gritty; harsh reality.
Pastel	Soft, light colours; lifestyle and beauty.
Monochrome	Black and white; timeless or stark.
Film stock look	Fine grain, gentle highlights; analogue warmth.
Neon cyberpunk	Magenta and cyan; night-city tech.
Natural Rec.709	True-to-life colour; documentary and training.
High-contrast commercial	Punchy, clean, saturated; product ads.

Transitions

Term	What it does
cut	Instant change; the default. (LahLah: cut)
crossfade	One shot dissolves into the next; time passes. (LahLah:

	crossfade)
slide	The next shot pushes the last off-screen. (LahLah: slide)
zoom	A zoom blur carries you into the next shot. (LahLah: zoom)
wipe	A line sweeps the new shot in. (LahLah: wipe)
dip	Fade through black or white; a chapter break. (LahLah: dip)
Match cut	Cut between two shapes or actions that rhyme (made with a cut).
Smash cut	Abrupt cut from quiet to loud, or back (made with a cut).
J-cut	The next scene's sound starts before its picture.
L-cut	This scene's sound carries over the next picture.

Pacing

Term	**What it does**
Slow burn	4-6 s shots; let moments breathe.
Conversational	3-4 s shots; follows dialogue.
Punchy	1-2 s shots; ads and hooks.
On the beat	Cuts land on the music's beats.
Speed ramp	Slows down or speeds up inside one shot.
Hold on reaction	Stay on a face a beat longer than comfortable.